

PHOTOSYNTHESIS BEAT BOARD

Photosynthesis is a plant-based animated musical comedy set in a world inhabited by photogenic plants, where a cilantro and salon owner named Rau Ram tries to earn her green card in a garden that does not welcome her, her son Parsley, or other transplants.

Act 1 (Photosyn-Thesis)

World before the story.

Setup

Goal: 1 - 10

Rau Ram, a cilantro and expectant mother, emigrates to Dirty City. She could not find a home for her salon business. However, Malus, a nightclub owner and landlord, offers her their spare plot of land. The difference between them is night and day for the nightclub owner and salon owner. She soon has a son named Parsley.

Opening Image

Goal: 1 - 2

A lonely photo and immigration case file of Rau Ram, an expectant mother on her way to Dirty City, Woodwork.

Catalyst

Goal: 12 - 12½

After a dozen years, Rau's green card application is finally up for review. It comes at a time when more "invasive species" are forcefully coming out of Woodwork. She's only able to stay in this garden because her son is a natural born citizen. With a green card, she can legally own Salontro and get it off Malus's hand.

Theme Stated

Goal: 5 - 5½

"A green card ain't green on the other side." - Malus Crabapple

Rau believes a green card would grant her a place in the nation's soil. It can be as lonesome as not having one. Her photos are just her and her son now, but as they better the community, she will learn what it means to belong.

Debate

Goal: 12 - 25

Pyrus, a pear suspended from their conservatory, visits town and stays with their unty Malus. They befriend the well-behave Parsley. Rau sees Pyrus as a bad influence.

Break into Two

Goal: 25 - 25½

Rau could never save up when paying rent. However, Malus strikes a deal that they won't charge them if Parsley is Pyrus's school tutor.

Break into Two (reminder)

Act Two, that is; it is where we leave the "Thesis" world behind and enter the upside-down "Anti-thesis" world of Act Two. The hero makes a choice — and his/her journey begins.

Act 2 (Anti-PS-thesis)

Bizarro version of the world in Act 1.

Fun and Games

Goal: 30 - 55

Overtime, Rau saves enough to purchase Salontro. Parsley seems queer and weird to Rau. Malus asks Rau to come to their summer solstice retreat. Parsley opens up and asks to hang out with Pyrus as friends in Cantaloupe Outlets. Rau receives her green card in the mail. She cannot hold this news any longer and goes to see Parsley. She finds Parsley and Pyrus wearing crop tops which makes her lash out.

B Story

Goal: 30 - 30½

Rau needs all hands on deck to save up to purchase Salontro, while Parsley plays hooky with Pyrus and does everything they can to hide their adventures.

Midpoint

Goal: 55 - 55½

Rau does this summer solstice retreat to get on Malus's good side in buying Salontro. While on the retreat with Malus, she learns about Malus being kicked out by their parents for being queer and how they found a home in FigLeaf and their experience with immigrants. Malus gifts the deed to Salontro at no charge.

Bad Guys Close In

Goal: 55 - 75

Parsley sneaks out. Pyrus has an unlawful rave at FigLeaf that leads to Parsley's hospitalization and their arrest. Dirty City shuts down FigLeaf. Hoping to keep the family integrity, Rau decides not to stick up for Malus and blames their community for "misleading" her son.

All Is Lost

Goal: 75 - 75½

Rau keeps Salontro salon, but her son Parsley won't speak to her. She loses her regulars and lives on her savings.

Dark Night of the Soul

Goal: 75 - 85

Parsley runs away with Pyrus to their hometown of Mt. Woodwork. No one will help even a Woodwork citizen find her son. Rau is alone ("A green card ain't green on the other side").

Break into Three

Goal: 85 - 85½

On a calendar, Rau looks at past photos of her and Parsley. It's been a photo of her alone these past many days. She finds the photobooth photo of Parsley and Pyrus. It's the happiest Parsley has ever been.

Finale

Goal: 85 - 110

In a city auction, Rau almost wins FigLeaf's domain, but Dandy Lyon Estate outbids. Rau squats on the premises, halting the demolition. She gains public support but is alone in a water-hunger strike. Secretary of Garden Security Rhizo and their Transplant Service Officers revoke Rau's green card. Seeing the news, Parsley worries. He returns, making Rau leave her post. FigLeaf gets bulldozed. Rhizo chases Rau into Salontro, but Pyrus traps Rhizo in a tanning bed. Changed by its magic, Rhizo threatens the developers with legal action for exploitations of transplants. Rau knows she'll have to wait another dozen years for her green card to be reconsidered. Malus builds Fig Palace. She uses her savings to create an internship for Pyrus.

Final Image

Goal: 109½ - 110

A group photo of Rau surrounded by those who love her.